IU International

Final Assessment Introduction to PHP — CORRECTION GUIDE

Discipline: Introduction to PHP | Data: 05/07/2026 | Duration: 90 Minutes

Total: 100.00 points

Session 1 — General concepts

1. Which of the following best describes PHP? 10.00 pts

A) A client-side scripting language used for web design

B) A server-side scripting language used for web development ✓

C) A database management system

D) A markup language for creating web pages

EXPECTED ANSWER:
A server-side scripting language used for web development

EVALUATION CRITERIA:
Correct answer identifies PHP as a server-side scripting language. Other options are distractors.

2. What is the correct way to start a PHP code block? 10.00 pts

A) <?php ✓

B) <script language='php'>

C) <?

D) <php>

EXPECTED ANSWER:
<?php

EVALUATION CRITERIA:
Correct answer is the standard opening tag. Other options represent common mistakes.

3. Which of the following is NOT a typical capability of PHP as mentioned in the lecture? 10.00 pts

A) Generate dynamic page content

B) Collect form data

C) Directly run on the client's browser without a server ✓

D) Create, open, read, write, delete, and close files on the server

EXPECTED ANSWER:
Directly run on the client's browser without a server

EVALUATION CRITERIA:

Correct answer identifies the statement that contradicts PHP's server-side nature. Other options are valid capabilities.

4. What is the role of a web server in running PHP? 10.00 pts

A) It stores PHP files and sends them directly to the browser

B) It executes the PHP script and sends the resulting HTML to the client ✓

C) It compiles PHP into machine code before sending to the client

D) It is only needed for databases, not for PHP execution

EXPECTED ANSWER:
It executes the PHP script and sends the resulting HTML to the client

EVALUATION CRITERIA:
Correct answer describes the server's role in executing PHP and returning HTML. Other options are incorrect or incomplete.

Session 2 — PHP Data Types

1. List four different PHP data types and provide a brief example of each. 10.00 pts

EXPECTED ANSWER:
Examples include: integer (e.g., 5), float/double (e.g., 3.14), string (e.g., "hello"), boolean (e.g., true), array (e.g., array(1,2,3)), object, NULL, resource. Any four distinct types with correct examples are acceptable.

EVALUATION CRITERIA:
Full credit (10 pts): Lists four distinct PHP data types and provides a correct example for each. Partial credit: 2.5 pts per correct type with example; if example is missing or incorrect for a type, deduct 2.5 pts for that item. No credit if fewer than two correct types with examples.

2. Explain the difference between an integer and a float data type in PHP. Provide a code snippet that demonstrates how to check the type of a variable. 10.00 pts

EXPECTED ANSWER:
An integer is a whole number without a decimal point (e.g., 42). A float (or double) is a number with a decimal point (e.g., 3.14). To check the type, use var_dump() or gettype(). Example: $x = 5; var_dump($x); // outputs int(5). $y = 5.5; var_dump($y); // outputs float(5.5).

EVALUATION CRITERIA:
Full credit (10 pts): Clearly explains the difference and provides a correct code snippet using var_dump() or gettype(). Partial credit: 5 pts for correct explanation but incomplete or incorrect code; 5 pts for correct code but weak explanation. Deduct 2 pts for minor errors like missing semicolon or wrong function name.

3. What is a boolean data type in PHP? Give an example of a boolean value and explain how it can be used in a conditional statement. 10.00 pts

EXPECTED ANSWER:
A boolean represents a truth value: either true or false. Example: $isReady = true;. It can be used in an if statement: if ($isReady) { echo "Ready"; } else { echo "Not ready"; }.

EVALUATION CRITERIA:
Full credit (10 pts): Correct definition, example, and usage in a conditional. Partial credit: 4 pts for definition, 3 pts for example, 3 pts for conditional usage. Deduct 2 pts if the example is not a valid boolean literal.

4. Describe the NULL data type in PHP. Write a line of PHP code that assigns a NULL value to a variable and then another line that checks if the variable is NULL. 10.00 pts

EXPECTED ANSWER:
NULL represents a variable with no value or uninitialized. Code: $var = NULL; if (is_null($var)) { echo "Variable is NULL"; } or if ($var === NULL) { ... }.

EVALUATION CRITERIA:
Full credit (10 pts): Accurate description and correct code with assignment and check. Partial credit: 5 pts for description, 5 pts for code. Deduct 2 pts if the check uses == instead of === or is_null().

Session 3 — PHP Variables

1. In PHP, which of the following statements about variable scope is TRUE? 10.00 pts

A) Variables declared inside a function are only accessible within that function. ✓

B) Variables declared outside a function are automatically accessible inside the function without any keyword.

C) The 'global' keyword is used to declare a variable inside a function that can only be used inside that function.

D) PHP variables have no scope; they are always accessible from anywhere in the script.

EXPECTED ANSWER:
Variables declared inside a function are only accessible within that function.

EVALUATION CRITERIA:
The student must correctly identify the concept of local scope in PHP. Full credit for selecting the correct option; no partial credit.

2. Consider the following PHP code: <?php $x = 5; function test() { echo $x; } test(); ?> What will be the output? 10.00 pts

A) 5

B) An error or notice is produced because $x is not accessible inside the function. ✓

C) null

D) 0

EXPECTED ANSWER:
An error or notice is produced because $x is not accessible inside the function.

EVALUATION CRITERIA:
The student must understand that a variable defined outside a function is not automatically available inside it (local scope). Full credit for the correct option; no partial credit.